



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from Lithuania. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in danish.

What educational path would you recommend for me?

That's a great position to be in — finishing primary school and thinking carefully about your future is a big step. In Denmark, you have several good options depending on your interests, strengths, and long-term goals. Here's a breakdown of the most common educational paths after primary school (folkeskolen), along with recommendations based on your background:

🎓 1. Gymnasiale Uddannelser (Upper Secondary Education)

This is the most common choice for students aiming for university later. There are different types:

♦ STX (Studentereksamen)

- Focus: Broad academic subjects – humanities, sciences, social sciences.
- Good for: Keeping doors open, going to university.
- Recommendation: If you're still exploring your interests and want general academic skills.

♦ HHX (Higher Commercial Examination)

- Focus: Business, economics, international trade, marketing.
- Good for: Business careers or university studies related to economics or management.
- Recommendation: A great fit if you're interested in business or want international career options (which could tie in well with your Lithuanian background).

♦ HTX (Higher Technical Examination)

- Focus: Technology, science, engineering.
- Good for: Engineering, IT, natural sciences at university or technical careers.
- Recommendation: Choose this if you love science, tech, or want a future in engineering or similar fields.

♦ HF (Higher Preparatory Examination)

- Focus: Shorter, more flexible, good for older students or those who didn't do 9th/10th grade exams.
- Good for: Getting into higher education later without committing to 3 years.
- Recommendation: Not usually the first choice after primary school, but useful in some cases.

2. Erhvervsuddannelser (Vocational Education and Training - EUD)

- Focus: Hands-on skills, leading to a skilled trade (e.g., electrician, carpenter, chef, hairdresser, etc.).
- Combines: School with practical work/apprenticeship.
- Duration: 2–5 years, depending on the program.
- Recommendation: Great if you want to work with your hands, enter the workforce sooner, and earn while you learn. Denmark has a strong system for this.

3. International Possibilities

Since you have a Lithuanian background and fluency in Danish, you could also look into:

- **IB (International Baccalaureate):** If available in your area, this is an international upper-secondary program in English, widely accepted by universities worldwide. Great if you're considering studying abroad.
- **Bilingual or multicultural education:** Some schools may offer programs where you can build on your Lithuanian heritage and language skills (e.g., extra language subjects).

Recommendations Based on You

Since you're:

- Fluent in Danish
- From a multicultural background
- Just finishing primary school in Denmark
- Open-minded and considering options

I'd recommend this approach:

1. **If you're academically inclined and want to keep doors open:**
→ **STX** or **HHX** would be a great fit.
2. **If you're curious about tech, science, or innovation:**
→ **HTX** could be an exciting choice.
3. **If you're more practical and want to work sooner:**
→ Explore **EUD** in areas that interest you (many programs even offer paths to higher education later).
4. **If you might want to study or work abroad someday:**
→ Consider **IB** or **HHX**, as they offer strong international perspectives.

Next Steps

- Visit your local **UU-vejledning (Youth Guidance Center)** – they can help tailor advice to you.
- Attend **open house events** at nearby schools.

- Talk to older students or friends who've taken different paths.
- Consider doing a **10th grade (10. klasse)** if you're unsure — it's a great year to mature, explore interests, and prepare better.

Would you like help exploring specific schools or programs near you in Denmark?